Ford Motor Company

December 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 00S43: Certain 2000 Model Year Mustang GT – Intake Manifold Replacement

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2000 model year Mustang GT vehicles built at the Dearborn Assembly Plant from April 1, 2000 through June 30, 2000.

SAFETY CONCERN

In some of the affected vehicles, an incorrect intake manifold, which does not have a passage to provide coolant flow to the heater, may have been installed. Without coolant flow, the heater is inoperative in all modes (blower blows cold air, no-heat). In adverse weather, the loss of the "Defrost" mode could affect driver visibility, and potentially, result in an accident.

SERVICE ACTION

Owners will be notified by first class mail that a special program has been set-up, whereby Ford Customer Relationship Center (CRC) representatives will contact the owners of affected vehicles, to inquire about the presence or lack of heat and defrost capability. For customers who have vehicles without heat or defrost, the Customer Relationship Center will facilitate the arrangement of an appointment with the dealer of their choice to have the intake manifold replaced. The CRC will also arrange for the direct shipment of a replacement intake manifold and gaskets to the selected dealer.

In cases where the customer arrives at the dealership with a 'no-heat' concern, provide a copy of the owner letter to the customer and inspect the vehicle for eligibility based on Build Date and, if necessary, perform the intake manifold replacement.

Vehicles with the lack of heat for reasons other than the incorrect manifold are covered under warranty. Follow Workshop Manual diagnostic and repair procedures.

PLEASE NOTE

Check and, if necessary, correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……..……....1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……..……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 00S43
Certain 2000 Mustang GT Vehicles
Intake Manifold Replacement

OASIS

OASIS will **not** be activated for this program. Customers will be directed to the dealership at the request of the Ford Customer Relationship Center.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly check and, if necessary, correct any in-stock units and other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Customers will be directed to your dealership based on their response to a personal telephone inquiry from the Ford Customer Relationship Center. This will determine the need for repairs based on a "heat-defrost" question.

REGIONAL CONTACT

None required.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid intake manifold repairs (for a no-heat condition) made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel which will be at owner's expense. Enter the word "RENTAL" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area of the recall claim. Use ESP cost guidelines.

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LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect DEALER STOCK UNITS for heat. Allow 10 minutes for warm-up. Check for heat from the defroster ducts.	00S43A	0.3 Hours
Inspect for heat and replace Intake Manifold (applies to DEALER STOCK units only)	00S43B	2.0 Hours
Replace Intake Manifold (applies to CUSTOMER vehicles ONLY)	00S43C	1.7 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will be direct shipped for this recall. For dealer stock units that fail the inspection, call the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 and be prepared to provide the VIN and P&A code. In cases where the customer is directed to your dealership through contact with the Customer Relationship Center, the Intake Manifold and Gaskets will be direct shipped ahead of the customer appointment.

Part Number	Description	Quantity
1L2Z-9424-DA	Intake Manifold	1
XL3Z-9439-AA	Intake Manifold Gasket	2
VC-4-A	Premium Engine Coolant (Green)	5 Qts.*

NOTE: Of the 12,700 vehicles in the affected population, less than **50** will require intake manifold replacement.

*The amounts listed are the *maximum* coolant amounts for claims purposes. Vehicles require coolant to be mixed with an equal amount of water.

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DOR/COR

DOR/COR Number 50208 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

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Certain 2000 Mustang GT Vehicles
Intake Manifold Replacement

Refer to Section 303-01C of the 2000 model year Workshop Manual for Intake Manifold replacement procedures.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

December 2000

00S43

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has determined that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2000 Mustang GT vehicles.

What the safety issue is …	In some of the affected vehicles, an incorrect intake manifold may have been installed which does not have a passage to provide coolant flow to the heater. Without coolant flow, the heater is inoperative in all modes. In adverse weather, the loss of the "Defrost" mode could affect driver visibility, and potentially, result in an accident.
What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...	Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall will be contacted by telephone in mid-January, 2001. A representative from the Customer Relationship Center will inquire if you have "heat-defrost" capability. If not, you will be requested to return your vehicle to the dealer for replacement of the intake manifold.
How long will it take?	The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do …

If you notice this concern prior to being contacted by the Customer Relationship Center, feel free to contact your dealer immediately. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 00S43.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've already paid for this service …

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 or 1-888-327-4863.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs